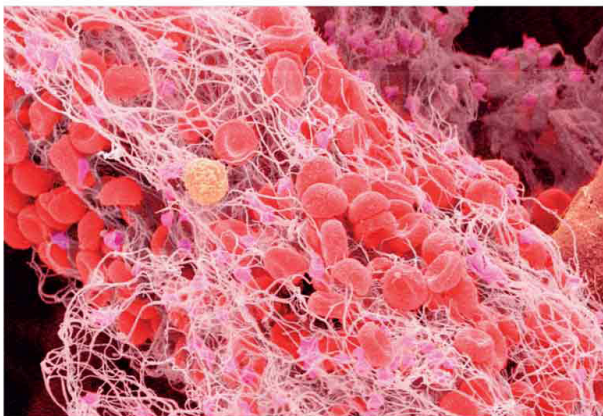


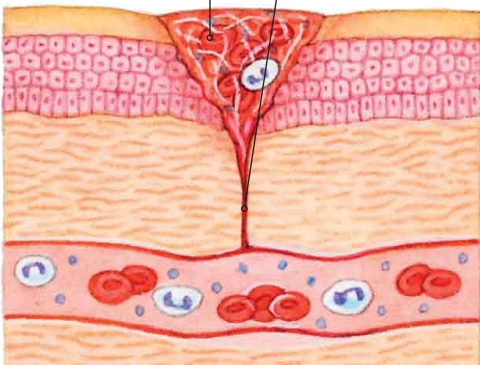


Fibrin threads

Taken using a scanning electron microscope, this image shows a magnified view of a blood clot shortly after it formed. The red blood cells are trapped in a tight mesh of fibrin threads that looks like a fishing net.

CLOT

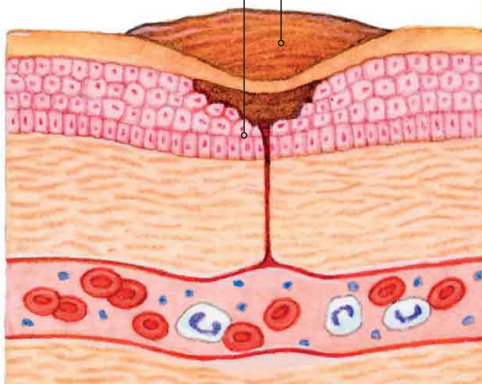
Contracted clot
Wound sealed



Fibrin threads inside the clot contract and pull the edges of the wound together to prevent leakage.

SCAB

Repaired tissue
Hard scab



A **scab** is formed on the surface of the clot. The hard scab protects the wound site as tissues are repaired.